



IN-GAME REWARD SYSTEMS

Are they even worth it anymore?

By Paarth “Cruciator” Pareek

feedback@skoar.in

We've all been there, excited for a new in-game event to begin, waiting to reap the benefits of our hard work and show off the new rewards that we got in return. But that was back in the day. Now, things have changed. You're just one of millions who got the exact same skin for logging into the game for a week and you all now look the same. Which begs the question, are these in-game reward systems even worth it anymore?

Before we move any further, let's establish what we constitute as an in-game reward. An in-game reward could be a skin for a particular character, an item in the game that you get for completing certain achievements, or simply an emote. Either way, these rewards incentivise players to grind and get that item for themselves so they are able to show it off to the world.

Why was this system brought into place?

As we mentioned above, game developers wanted a way to make sure people kept playing their game. The first ever method was implemented back in the 1970s when the scoring

system was first introduced into games. This was a time when game arcades were huge and had kids flocking to play their games. This brought a certain level of competitiveness in players who were already spending hours and hours of their time in arcades. This naturally led to them spending more money as well in pursuit of local fame.

Soon, these prizes began evolving when ticket systems were introduced. One could get tickets based on their performance in a game and then pool those tickets together in exchange for a real-world prize of some kind. These methods set the foundation for the next generation of video games.

The evolution of In-Game Rewards

Even though high scores were an



amazing accomplishment to have for a person who spent hours of their time at a game arcade, there were other things on the horizon for video games and their methods for player retention.

As game consoles were released and arcades started going out of business, each game developer or studio needed to figure out a way to incentivise people to keep playing their game. It was no longer a matter of how many machines they sold, it was all about the physical copies of the games that they had probably spent years developing.

For this exact reason, devs started handing out rewards to players for spending more time in their games.

In-game levels were introduced and you could tell how experienced the player was at the game just by the level that the person had. There were certain things in the game that you could only get if you progressed past a certain point. These were things you could show off to your friends and other people who played the same game.

Things didn't stop there however, games like Call of Duty brought in skins for their multiplayer modes where you could unlock gun-specific